Interview guide

25A. Interview Guide

Items: 5

25.1 Frontend Interview Formats — What to Expect at Different Company Types

Big Tech (Google, Amazon, Microsoft, Meta)

Typically 4-5 rounds over one day (virtual or on-site):

Round 1: DSA/Coding (45-60 min) — 1-2 LeetCode-style problems. For frontend, problems lean toward arrays, strings, trees, and hash maps. Usually medium difficulty.

Round 2: Machine Coding (60-90 min) — Build a UI component or small application. Evaluate: working code, component structure, edge cases, keyboard/accessibility, clean code.

Round 3: Frontend System Design (45-60 min) — Design a large-scale frontend application. "Design the frontend for Google Docs" or "Design Instagram's feed."

Round 4: Behavioral (45 min) — STAR-format answers. Leadership principles (Amazon), Googleyness (Google), or general culture fit.

Round 5 (sometimes): Bar Raiser / Cross-functional — Another behavioral or coding from a different team.

Round 1: Machine Coding (60-90 min) — The highest-weight round. Build something functional. Often more complex than Big Tech machine coding.

Round 2: Theory / Problem Solving (45-60 min) — JavaScript concepts, browser fundamentals, and short coding problems (debounce, Promise.all).

Round 3: System Design (45-60 min) — For 3+ year candidates.

Round 4: Behavioral / Hiring Manager (30-45 min) — Culture fit, career goals.

Funded Startups (Series A-C)

Round 1: Take-home assignment (2-4 hours) — Build a small project. Evaluated on code quality, architecture, testing.

Round 2: Technical discussion (60 min) — Walk through your take-home + theory.

Round 3: Founder/CTO chat (30-45 min) — Culture, product sense.

25.2 Behavioral Round — STAR Method and 7 Must-Prepare Questions

Situation — Context in 2-3 sentences. **Task** — YOUR responsibility. **Action** — What YOU did (60% of answer). **Result** — Quantified outcome.

The 7 Questions

1. **"Tell me about a time you disagreed with a technical decision."** Show you can push back respectfully AND commit when overruled.

2. **"Describe a project you're most proud of."** Measurable impact. "I led" not "we did."

3. **"How do you handle tight deadlines?"** Prioritization: what you cut (scope), what you kept (quality), how you communicated trade-offs.

5. "How do you prioritize when everything is urgent?" Actual vs perceived urgency. Highest business impact first. Negotiate timelines for the rest.

6. "Describe a time you had to learn something quickly." Show your learning process, not just the outcome.

7. "Tell me about a bug that was really hard to track down." Systematic debugging process matters more than the bug itself.

Tips: Keep each answer under 3 minutes. Prepare 5-6 rotatable stories. Always end with what you learned.

25.3 Salary Negotiation

Understanding Compensation

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Total Compensation (TC) = Base + Bonus + Equity + Benefits

  Indian Product Company (SDE-2, 4 years):
    Base: ₹18-25 LPA | Bonus: ₹2-5 LPA | ESOPs: ₹3-10 LPA
    TC: ₹23-40 LPA

  Big Tech India (L4/SDE-2, 4 years):
    Base: ₹25-35 LPA | Bonus: ₹3-6 LPA | RSUs: ₹8-20 LPA
    TC: ₹36-60 LPA
```

Research Before the Interview

levels.fyi, Glassdoor, AmbitionBox, Blind, Grapevine/Fishbowl.

Negotiation Scripts

given my [specific relevant skill]."

When given an offer: "Thank you. I'd like time to review the full package. Can I get back by [date]?" — NEVER accept or negotiate on the spot.

Counter-offer: "Based on my experience with [skill], I was hoping the base could be closer to [X]. Is there flexibility?"

What most candidates don't negotiate: Signing bonus, ESOP grant size, review cycle timing, remote flexibility, title.

25.4 Resume and Portfolio

The 10-Second Scan

Hiring managers check: current role/company, years of experience, tech stack (React, TypeScript, Next.js), impact numbers.

Impact Descriptions

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BAD: "Worked on the frontend of an e-commerce app using React and Redux."

  GOOD: "Built product search for a marketplace serving 2M monthly users.
  Implemented faceted search with instant filtering, reducing search-to-pu
  time by 35%. Migrated Redux to TanStack Query, cutting bundle size by 28
```

Formula: [Action verb] + [specific feature] + [scale] + [measurable impact]

GitHub: 2-3 polished projects with READMEs, live demos, tests.

Portfolio site: Fast (Lighthouse > 90), accessible, well-designed. The site itself is a portfolio piece.

25.5 30-Day Preparation Plan

Track A: 1-3 Years Experience

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Week 1: JavaScript core, HTML/CSS (Ch 1-3), 2 machine coding components
  Week 2: React hooks (Ch 16), TypeScript basics (Ch 4A), 3 MC components
  Week 3: Web fundamentals (Ch 5), Data structures (Ch 22), JS polyfills (
  Week 4: Web security (Ch 6), full MC mock, behavioral prep (Ch 25.2),
          quick revision (Ch 25B), mock interview, rest
```

Track B: 3-6 Years Experience

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Week 1: Rendering patterns (Ch 7), system design (Ch 11, 3 problems),
          design patterns (Ch 9)
  Week 2: Optimization (Ch 8), TypeScript advanced (Ch 4B-C),
          advanced MC components
  Week 3: System design (5-6 more problems), state management (Ch 10),
          testing + build tools (Ch 21-22)
  Week 4: JS problems SDE2 (Ch 18), Next.js (Ch 14), system design mock,
          MC mock, behavioral + salary research, revision, rest
```

Daily: 2-3 hours. Morning: read/study (1hr). Evening: practice/code (1-2hr).

QUICK CHECK — no marks, just for you.

1. According to the lesson, which round carries the highest weight in the interview loop at Indian product companies such as Flipkart, Swiggy, and Razorpay?

- ○ DSA/Coding — one or two LeetCode-style medium problems on arrays, strings, and trees
- ○ Behavioral / Hiring Manager — culture fit and career goals

- Machine Coding — building something functional, often more complex than Big Tech machine coding
- Frontend System Design — designing a large-scale application end to end

Check answer

2. You are structuring a behavioral answer with the STAR method as described in the lesson. How should the four parts be balanced?

- Action should occupy roughly 60% of the answer, with Situation kept to 2-3 sentences of context
- Situation should occupy roughly 60% of the answer so the interviewer fully understands the context
- All four parts should get roughly equal time so the story stays balanced
- Result should occupy roughly 60% of the answer since interviewers only care about outcomes

Check answer

3. A recruiter calls and verbally presents you an offer. Based on the lesson's negotiation guidance, what is the recommended immediate response?

- Thank them, ask for time to review the full package, and propose a date to get back
- Counter immediately with your target base while you still have their attention
- Accept on the call to show enthusiasm, then renegotiate after signing
- Disclose your current salary so they can calibrate the offer fairly

Check answer

Previous

Applications and advanced

Next

Quick revision sheets

LEARN MORE

ARTICLES & DOCS

Front-End Interview Playbook
greatfrontend.com

VIDEOS



How to prepare for front-end interviews
YouTube



Ultimate front-end interview prep guide
YouTube



How to prepare for FE coding interviews
YouTube

Hand-picked references for this lesson.